

Will McGowan

9 Clarendon Place, Glasgow G20 7PZ

+44 7562 299 515 | mcgowanwill366@gmail.com

6 October 2026

Graduate Recruitment Team

Peel Hunt

100 Liverpool Street

London EC2M 2AT

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am applying for the Investment Banking Graduate Programme in London. I am a final-year Economics student at the University of Strathclyde, graduating in summer 2027 with a predicted 2:1. Peel Hunt's best-ever investment banking revenue in the year to March 2026 shows a UK mid-cap franchise that is growing, and a twelve-month graduate programme built to make new analysts useful quickly.

My clearest preparation for banking has been taking transactions apart. As co-founder and Treasurer of the Strathclyde Agricapital Society, the university's first agri-finance society, I grew membership to 126 and led weekly research sessions on deals such as Olam Agri's USD 1.24bn stake sale to SALIC, explaining the strategic rationale, the deal structure and the valuation to members, including many from outside finance. My strongest academic results are in the same territory: 90% in first-year Finance and 78%, the second-highest mark, in a third-year group project for Advanced Corporate Finance and Financial Markets.

Investment banking appeals to me because every transaction is a chain of judgements about who should buy, why now and at what price, and each one has to survive scrutiny from clients and counterparties. The analyst's part in that chain is accuracy under deadline, a habit I have built outside the classroom. For nearly two years at KONG, I reconciled end-of-shift cash and card takings while studying full-time. I now run the drinks programme as Head Mixologist at Le Set, a new 200-cover Glasgow venue, where I wrote the batch specifications and trained around 15 bar staff to standards that have to hold when someone else executes them.

Peel Hunt stands out to me because it combines corporate advice with broking and distribution, so its bankers see a transaction from the company's side and the investor's side at once; its recent mandates range from IQE's £81 million fundraising to acting as lead financial adviser to Treatt. Mid-cap transactions are where a graduate can see every stage of a deal, and I would like to bring the accuracy under deadline I built at KONG and Le Set to a team of Peel Hunt's size.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours faithfully,

Will McGowan